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Newsletter



An Ambitious NIH Effort to Improve Autism Care

According to the latest CDC data, the prevalence of autism spectrum disorder (ASD) in today's eight-year-olds is about one in 31. But despite its prevalence, many families trying to support children diagnosed with ASD continue to face complexity and uncertainty.

International Women's Day 2026

To recognize International Women's Day, SRI shared on its website the stories of four women whose work delivered fundamental advances in computer science:



Elizabeth "Jake" Feinler. Jake Feinler pivoted to the emerging field of information science when she joined SRI in 1960. As SRI's work on computing and networking accelerated, Feinler managed the Network Information Center and registered the first commercial domain name. Feinler was elected to the Internet Hall of Fame in 2012.

Helen Chan Wolf. An AI pioneer who fundamentally advanced autonomous robotics, Helen Wolf quickly established a reputation as a bold and forward-thinking scientist. In its feature on "The Secret History of Facial Recognition," *Wired* chronicles some of Wolf's important pre-SRI work. Wolf played key roles in developing Shakey (the first robot to navigate and reason with AI).

Barbara Grosz. Barbara Grosz is recognized as a major figure in maturing two vastly influential computing disciplines: natural language (NL) processing and multi-agent systems.

One of the most important outcomes of her work at SRI was the first computational model of dialog. She has received numerous awards.

Martha E. Pollack. Martha Pollack joined SRI's AI Center in 1985 and began investigating resource-bounded agents, resource-bounded practical reasoning, semantic and pragmatic interpretation, theories of intention, and agent architectures, to better understand and model machine intelligence. She has received numerous awards.



Mission to Study the Northern Lights

By providing data from the SRI-operated Poker Flat Incoherent Scatter Radar, SRI scientists are helping NASA better understand the electrical currents in ionospheric plasma.

ARC to PARC (and back?)

In the late 1950s through 1970s, Doug Engelbart assembled and led an amazingly talented team of innovators at SRI in his Augmentation Research Center (ARC). Much of that team left for Xerox's Palo Alto Research Center (PARC) in the 1970s, and now, decades later, PARC has become a part of SRI. What factors led to these events?



In Memoriam

We note the passing of: Renée Lee Cameto, Steven Cheung, Jacob Goldberg, Stephen Wayne Noble, William Hamilton Paxton, and Carolyn Green Westgaard